

# Cubs Practice #2 — Coaches Quick Sheet

6:30–8:00 PM | 90 Minutes | Rookie Coach Pitch

## 6:30–6:42 — Warm-Up + Progressive Catch

- Quick dynamic warm-up
- Partner throwing — start close, gradually increase distance
- Catching: move feet, get behind the ball, secure it first
- Progress to firmer throws
- Watch: arm strength, accuracy, receiving ability

## 6:42–7:18 — 3 Stations

3 groups • 4 players • 12 minutes each

| Station                                                                                                         | Coach / Area             | Focus                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
|  Catcher Evaluation          | Keith —<br>Home/Backstop | Receiving, blocking, movement,<br>throws   |
|  Live Hitting                | AC — Batting Cages       | Coach pitch / evaluate hitters             |
|  Infield + Game<br>Awareness | AC — Infield             | Ground balls, making plays,<br>baseball IQ |

## Station 1 — Catcher Evaluation

- Get each candidate into full gear
- Setup + give pitcher a good target
- Receive live pitches
- Mix in balls outside the zone / in the dirt
- Recover passed balls
- Finish with throws

**LOOK FOR:** Receiving • willingness to stay behind ball • mobility • blocking • communication • arm/accuracy

*Goal: Leave practice with 2–3 additional viable catcher options.*

## Station 2 — Live Hitting

This is also a batting-order evaluation.

- Coach pitch — game-like reps
- Give each player plenty of hittable pitches
- Mix in a few tougher pitches once they're comfortable
- Track quality of contact, not just whether they hit it
- Finish each player's turn with a few competitive/game-speed pitches

**LOOK FOR:** Contact consistency • hard contact • swing mechanics • pitch tracking • confidence • speed out of the box

*Goal: Start identifying top/middle/bottom of the lineup and kids who consistently put the ball in play.*

## Station 3 — Infield + Game Awareness

- Ground balls from SS / 2B / P areas
- Make the play at 1B
- Introduce runners/situations as appropriate
- Before each rep ask: “Where's the play?”
- Move kids around the infield

**EMPHASIZE:** Ready position • field first • set feet • accurate throw • know the play before the ball is hit

## 7:18–7:45 — Coach Pitch Scrimmage / Live Defense

Bring everyone back together.

- Full defensive field
- Continue rotating catcher candidates
- Live coach pitch
- Hitters run everything out
- Defensive situations / outs
- “Where's the play?” before each batter
- Keep instruction short and maximize reps

**HITTING:** Continue watching who makes consistent game-speed contact — cage performance vs. live-field performance may be different.

## **7:45–8:00 — FLAME BALL CHALLENGE**

**Radar Gun — Fastest Strike**

- 3 throws per player
- **ONLY STRIKES COUNT**
- Record fastest strike
- Track season personal bests
- Encourage good mechanics + accuracy

*Season's fastest recorded strike wins the Flame Ball*

## **TODAY'S PRIORITIES**

1. Get a real look at every hitter → begin establishing batting order.
2. Identify 2–3 additional catcher options.
3. Improve infield decision-making and game awareness.
4. Evaluate players during both drills **AND** live play.
5. Lots of reps. Minimal standing around.